AI Reflection

For this assignment, I used ChatGPT as a coding assistant to build Card Game 24 step by step instead of asking it to generate the whole project at once. I started by asking for help planning the Python version, then worked through card generation, card-use validation, safe expression evaluation, and the solver one part at a time. One prompt I used was, "Help me implement only the first part of card24.py: randomly generate four valid Card Game 24 card values from 1 through 13 and display them clearly."

One issue I focused on was making sure duplicate cards were handled correctly, such as 3, 3, 8, 8. I also asked about safely evaluating expressions because the assignment warned against blindly using eval(). The final Python version used the AST module, while the web version used its own tokenizer and parser.

I also used AI to help understand and implement the recursive solver, then reused the same idea in JavaScript for the web version. For testing, I questioned whether it would be better to use a separate test file instead of manually entering every expression. This helped organize tests for valid and invalid expressions, duplicate cards, division, parentheses, division by zero, and incorrect card usage.

At the end, I asked the AI to compare my completed card24.py and card24.html against every assignment requirement. This helped confirm that the required features were present and also caught a small submission detail about making sure the Python file was named card24.py. Overall, AI was most useful for explaining ideas, checking my work, and helping me fix specific issues while I still had to understand and test the final result myself.